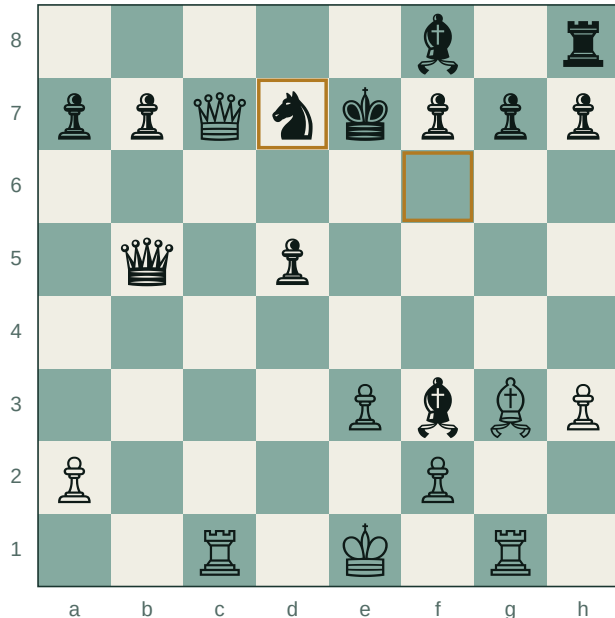


Attraction tactics: White, move 20

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 19...Nd7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

20. Qd6+ Kd8 21. Rc8+ Kxc8 22. Qc7#

20.Qd6+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From d6 it attacks king on e7 and knight on d7. Recorded reply: **20...Kd8**.

21.Rc8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **21...Kxc8**.

22.Qc7# Mate: queen on c7 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on c8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on c7. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on e7. Absolute pin: knight on d7.